ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 9 · SET 01

Max. Marks: 80 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct methods to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions — 20 questions · 20 marks

Select the most appropriate option. (20 × 1 = 20)

1. The 'Ring of Fire', a belt of frequent earthquakes and volcanoes, surrounds the:

(a) Atlantic Ocean (b) Pacific Ocean (c) Indian Ocean (d) Arctic Ocean

> **Ans: (b)** Most of the world's active volcanoes lie along the edge of the Pacific plate.

2. **Assertion (A):** Human society is complex.
Reason (R): No single field of study can fully explain human society.

> **Ans: (a)** Because society has many dimensions (economic, political, geographical, historical), several disciplines are needed.

3. A horse-shoe shaped lake formed when a river meander is cut off from the main stream is called a/an:

(a) lagoon (b) glacial tarn (c) crater lake (d) ox-bow lake

> **Ans: (d)** Formed by river deposition in the middle/lower course.

4. The height of a place above mean sea level is called its _____.

(a) altitude (b) latitude
(c) longitude (d) elevation angle

> **Ans: (a)** Altitude = height above mean sea level.

5. Read the statements and choose the correct option.
Statement 1: Weather refers to the day-to-day atmospheric conditions of a place.
Statement 2: Climate is the average weather of a place over a short span of one or two weeks.

(a) Both statements are correct
(b) Statement 1 is correct, Statement 2 is incorrect
(c) Statement 1 is incorrect, Statement 2 is correct
(d) Both statements are incorrect

> **Ans: (b)** Climate is the average weather over a long period (30 years or more).

6. The Production Possibility Curve (PPC) shows:

(a) unlimited production of two goods
(b) government expenditure on two goods
(c) the combinations of two goods that can be produced with all resources used efficiently
(d) only the maximum output of one good

> **Ans: (c)** Points on the curve = efficient use; outside = unattainable.

7. A farmer in a drought-prone area chooses to grow millets instead of paddy. The 'opportunity cost' of this decision is:

(a) the seeds of millets (b) the labour used on the farm
(c) the paddy crop given up (d) the rainfall received

> **Ans: (c)** Opportunity cost = value of the next best alternative forgone.

8. Match Column I with Column II and choose the correct option.

Column I	Column II

(a) Sanganakallu	1. Rock paintings, Madhya Pradesh
(b) Mehrgarh	2. Neolithic site in Karnataka
(c) Bhimbetka	3. Early farming site in Balochistan

(a) a-2, b-3, c-1 (b) a-2, b-1, c-3 (c) a-1, b-2, c-3 (d) a-3, b-1, c-2

> **Ans: (a)** Sanganakallu (Ballari, Karnataka) – Neolithic; Mehrgarh – early farming (Bolan valley); Bhimbetka – rock shelters with paintings.

9. Which statement about the Harappan site of Lothal is INCORRECT?

(a) It is located in Rajasthan.
(b) It is located in Gujarat.
(c) It had a dockyard.
(d) It was a centre of bead-making and trade.

> **Ans: (a)** Lothal is in Gujarat; Kalibangan is in Rajasthan.

10. **Assertion (A):** The Mahajanapada of Magadha became the most powerful kingdom of north India by the 4th century BCE.
Reason (R): Magadha had fertile land, iron deposits nearby and control of river routes.

> **Ans: (a)** Rich agriculture, iron ore, forests (elephants) and rivers helped Magadha.

11. Under the Mauryan empire, the capital city was:

(a) Ujjain (b) Taxila (c) Kannauj (d) Pataliputra

> **Ans: (d)** Pataliputra (modern Patna) was the Mauryan capital.

12. Rudradaman I engraved a long inscription in Sanskrit at:

(a) Allahabad (b) Junagadh (Girnar)
(c) Sanchi (d) Nasik

> **Ans: (b)** Junagadh rock also has Ashoka's edicts and a record of Skandagupta.

13. The right to vote of every adult citizen irrespective of caste, religion, gender, education or income is called:

(a) limited franchise (b) universal adult franchise
(c) property franchise (d) plural voting

> **Ans: (b)** Article 326; voting age is 18.

14. The Right to Information Act was passed in India in the year:

(a) 1950 (b) 1975 (c) 2005 (d) 2000

> **Ans: (c)** RTI Act, 2005 gives citizens access to government information.

15. Articles 19 to 22 of the Indian Constitution deal with the:

(a) Right to Freedom (b) Right to Equality
(c) Right against Exploitation (d) Right to Constitutional Remedies

> **Ans: (a)** Equality 14–18; Freedom 19–22; Exploitation 23–24.

16. When the price of oranges falls from ₹80/kg to ₹40/kg and a family's purchase rises from 1 kg to 3 kg, this illustrates the:

(a) Law of Supply (b) market equilibrium
(c) price floor (d) Law of Demand

> **Ans: (d)** Price falls → quantity demanded rises (inverse relation).

17. Read the statements and choose the correct option.
Statement 1: Market demand is obtained by adding the quantities demanded by all individual buyers at each price.
Statement 2: The market demand curve is always steeper than any individual demand curve.

(a) Both statements are correct
(b) Statement 1 is correct, Statement 2 is incorrect
(c) Statement 1 is incorrect, Statement 2 is correct
(d) Both statements are incorrect

> **Ans: (b)** Adding horizontally makes the market curve flatter, not steeper.

18. Which of the following is a public good?

(a) A private lawn
(b) A packet of biscuits
(c) A mobile phone
(d) Street light

> **Ans: (d)** Non-excludable and non-rivalrous benefits for everyone.

19. In which system do private enterprises and the government both take important economic decisions?

(a) Pure market economy
(b) Mixed economy
(c) Command economy only
(d) Barter economy

> **Ans: (b)** India is a mixed economy.

20. The thin layer of the atmosphere that absorbs harmful ultraviolet rays of the sun is the:

(a) ionosphere
(b) troposphere
(c) ozone layer in the stratosphere
(d) exosphere

> **Ans: (c)** Ozone (O_3) in the stratosphere.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Type — 4 questions · 8 marks

Each question carries 2 marks. Answer in about 40 words. (4 × 2 = 8)

21. Name any two landforms formed by the work of a river in its middle and lower course.

> 1 + 1: meanders, ox-bow lakes, flood plains, levees, deltas (any two).

22. What is meant by ‘opportunity cost’? Give one example from your surroundings.

> Definition (1): value of the next best alternative given up when a choice is made. Example (1): a student who chooses to play cricket instead of studying loses the study time.

OR

Explain the Production Possibility Curve with the help of an example.

> (1) PPC shows maximum combinations of two goods that can be produced with given resources and technology. (1) Example: a farm producing wheat and sugarcane — more wheat means less sugarcane.

23. State any two features of universal adult franchise in India.

> Any two (1 each): every citizen aged 18+ can vote; no discrimination on caste, religion, gender, education, income; one person one vote one value; no one can vote on behalf of another.

24. What is ‘purchasing power’? How does a rise in prices affect it?

> (1) Purchasing power is the quantity of goods and services that a given amount of money can buy. (1) When prices rise, the same money buys less, so purchasing power falls.

SECTION C — Short Answer Type — 5 questions · 15 marks

Each question carries 3 marks. Answer in about 60 words. (5 × 3 = 15)

25. Explain any three factors that contribute to climate change.

Any three (1 each): burning of fossil fuels, deforestation, industrial emissions / greenhouse gases, agriculture & livestock (methane), urbanisation, volcanic eruptions (natural).

26. How did the Huang He (Yellow River) and the Yangtze help in the growth of the Chinese civilisation?

Fertile alluvial soil (1) → farming of millet and rice (1); water for irrigation, transport and trade, settled villages and cities (1).

27. Describe the role of the media in a democracy.

Any three (1 each): informs citizens; acts as a watchdog on government; provides a platform for public opinion; helps citizens make informed choices at elections.

OR

Describe any three features of direct democracy.

Any three (1 each): people take decisions themselves; used in small communities; frequent public meetings/referendums; no intermediary representatives; e.g., ancient Athens, Swiss cantons.

28. Why is the market demand curve flatter than an individual demand curve? Explain with an example.

Market demand = horizontal sum of individual demands (1). At every price the total quantity is larger (1). Example: at ₹40/kg Srivalli buys 3 kg but 100 consumers buy 300 kg, so for the same price change the quantity changes more → flatter (1).

29. Explain any three factors other than price that influence the demand for a product.

Any three (1 each): income of consumers; prices of related goods (substitutes/complements); tastes and preferences; expectations about future prices; number of consumers.

SECTION D — Long Answer Type — 4 questions · 20 marks

Each question carries 5 marks. Answer in about 120 words. (4 × 5 = 20)

30. Draw a simple PPC for two goods and show the opportunity cost of moving from one combination to another.

Neat PPC with axes labelled (2). Two points marked (e.g., A: 100 wheat, 0 sugar; B: 80 wheat, 30 sugar) (1). Moving A→B: 20 units of wheat given up for 30 units of sugar = opportunity cost (1). Points inside = under-use, outside = unattainable (1).

OR

Discuss how market, planned and mixed economies answer the questions of what, how and for whom to produce.

Market (prices, profit; consumers decide) (1.5); planned (central authority decides) (1.5); mixed (both private and government; e.g., India) (1.5); conclusion/example (0.5).

31. What was the nature of political institutions in the Vedic period? Describe them.

Rajan as tribal chief; role of sabha and samiti (assemblies advising the king); vidatha; tribes (jana) → janapadas; kingship not strictly hereditary in early period; gifts/offerings (bali) as revenue. Any five points.

OR

Describe the nature of the family and society in the Vedic period.

Patriarchal joint family (kula); pastoral society; varna not rigid in the early period; women educated—Gargi, Maitreyi; property mostly cattle; hospitality; rituals (yajna). Any five points.

32. Describe the work and importance of the Delimitation Commission.

Redraws boundaries of constituencies (1); ensures roughly equal population per constituency (1); decides reserved seats for SC/ST (1); orders are final and cannot be challenged in court (1); importance for fair representation (1).

OR

Describe the importance of political parties in a democracy.

> Contest elections (1); form governments/opposition (1); make policies and mobilise opinion (1); link citizens and government (1); provide choice and accountability (1).

33. Analyse how demand and supply determine market price. What is market equilibrium? Does it always exist in the real world?

> Demand falls, supply rises as price rises (1); intersection = equilibrium price and quantity (1.5); excess supply/demand pushes price back (1); in reality shocks, seasons, controls disturb it, so equilibrium is a tendency not a certainty (1.5).

OR

Explain with examples how and why the government intervenes in markets.

> Why: protect consumers/producers, essential goods, correct unfairness (1.5). How: price ceiling (ration shops, 1), price floor (MSP, 1), taxes/subsidies (1), laws like Essential Commodities Act (0.5).

SECTION E — Source-based / Case-based Questions — 3 questions · 12 marks

Each question carries 4 marks (1 + 1 + 2). (3 × 4 = 12)

34. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*

"Erosion is the process by which soil, rocks and other surface material are worn away and carried from one place to another by natural agents such as water, wind, ice and waves. Unlike weathering, which only breaks down rocks, erosion involves movement of the broken material. There are different types of erosion — water erosion by rivers and rain, wind erosion in dry sandy areas, glacial erosion by moving ice and coastal erosion by sea waves. Erosion shapes landforms and can both create and destroy features of the Earth's surface."

(i) What is erosion?

> Wearing away and transport of surface material by natural agents.

(ii) Give one landform formed by the erosional work of glaciers.

> Cirque / U-shaped valley / arête.

(iii) Distinguish between weathering and erosion.

> Weathering: breaking down of rocks in place, no movement (1). Erosion: removal and transport of material by agents (1).

35. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*

"A mixed economy combines the features of both market and planned economies. In this system private individuals, enterprises and the government all play important roles in taking economic decisions. We also find large public sector companies that play a significant role in the market. In reality, most economies today have some features of a mixed system — private ownership with a certain degree of government regulation. India adopted a mixed economy after independence and became more market-oriented after 1991."

(i) What does a mixed economy combine?

> Features of market and planned economies.

(ii) Name two important participants in economic decision-making in a mixed economy.

> Private enterprises/individuals and the government.

(iii) Explain two features of a mixed economy with examples.

> Private ownership with regulation e.g. private companies regulated by SEBI (1); public sector enterprises e.g. Indian Railways/ONGC (1).

36. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*

"In a multi-party system several political parties contest elections and represent diverse voices and interests, giving people the power to choose those they consider most suitable. In elections to Parliament or the State Assemblies, the party or coalition that wins a majority of seats forms the government, while the others form the opposition. Political parties work within the framework of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, and are registered and recognised by the Election Commission of India."

(i) What does a multi-party system give to the people?

> Power to choose among different parties/candidates.

(ii) Which Act regulates the functioning of political parties and elections in India?

> Representation of the People Act, 1951.

(iii) How is the government formed in a multi-party system?

> Party/coalition with majority of seats forms government (1); the rest sit in opposition and check the government (1).

SECTION F — Map-based Question — 1 questions · 5 marks

(1 × 5 = 5)

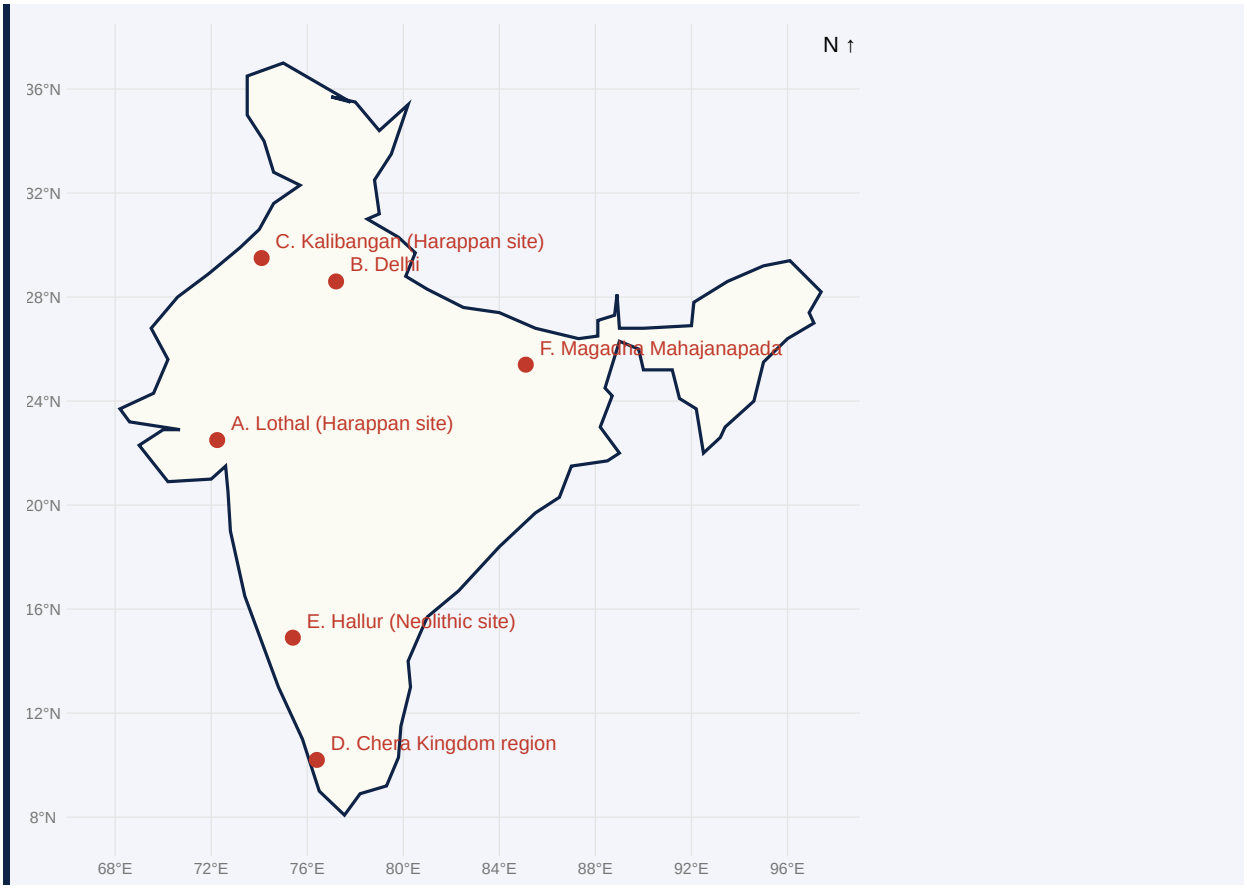
37. On the outline map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following (use the given letter/number for each): *Attempt any five. Each item carries 1 mark.*

A. Lothal (Harappan site)
B. Delhi
C. Kalibangan (Harappan site)
D. Chera Kingdom region
E. Hallur (Neolithic site)
F. Magadha Mahajanapada

Note — in lieu of Q.37, for visually impaired candidates only (answer any five):

1. Name the State/UT in which Lothal is located.
2. Name the State/UT in which Delhi is located.
3. Name the State/UT in which Kalibangan is located.
4. Name the State/UT in which Chera Kingdom region is located.
5. Name the State/UT in which Hallur is located.
6. Name the State/UT in which Magadha Mahajanapada is located.

> 1 mark for each correctly located and labelled item (any five). Correct positions are shown below; answers marked within a tolerance of about 150 km are acceptable.


N ↑
36°N
32°N
28°N
24°N
20°N
16°N
12°N
8°N
68°E
72°E
76°E
80°E
84°E
88°E
92°E
96°E
C. Kalibangan (Harappan site)
B. Delhi
F. Magadha Mahajanapada
A. Lothal (Harappan site)
E. Hallur (Neolithic site)
D. Chera Kingdom region